

Georgetown Orthodox Christian Fellowship

Vespers: Tuesday, August 25, 2026

**Memory of the Holy Martyrs Adrian and Natalie**

*Feel free to read or chant during the service!*

Stichera

**Tone 4. *If You, O Lord, should mark iniquities, O Lord, who shall stand? For with You there is forgiveness.***

When you witnessed the bravery \* and the dignified suffering \* of the holy Martyrs and their unyielding faith, \* then voluntarily you signed up for torture courageously, \* not betraying self-concern \* for your body, for love of God. And you finished all \* of the arduous contests resolutely, Martyr Adrian, and humbled \* the haughty pride of the enemy.

***Because of Your Name have I waited for You, O Lord; my soul has waited upon Your word, my soul has hoped in the Lord.*** When you witnessed the bravery \* and the dignified suffering \* of the holy Martyrs and their unyielding faith, \* then voluntarily you signed up for torture courageously, \* not betraying self-concern \* for your body, for love of God. And you finished all \* of the arduous contests resolutely, Martyr Adrian, and humbled \* the haughty pride of the enemy.

***From the morning watch until night, from the morning watch let Israel trust in the Lord.*** Undergoing imprisonment, \* being beaten with leather whips, \* weighted down with shackles of iron on your limbs, \* bearing the breaking of hands and legs, together with twenty-three \* other martyrs, you received \* all together the heavenly blessings from the Lord, \* Valiant Martyr St. Adrian. And through it all your godly wife Natalia \* was by your side and encouraged you. side and encouraged you. [ ]

***For with the Lord there is mercy and with Him is abundant redemption, and He will deliver Israel from all his iniquities.*** Undergoing imprisonment, \* being beaten with leather whips, \* weighted down with shackles of iron on your limbs, \* bearing the breaking of hands and legs, together with twenty-three \* other martyrs, you received \* all together the heavenly blessings from the Lord, \* Valiant Martyr St. Adrian. And through it all your godly wife Natalia \* was by your side and encouraged you.

***Praise the Lord, all you nations; praise Him, all you peoples.*** Adam's wife back in Paradise \* was the cause of his banishment, \* through the serpent's counsel. But now with Adrian, \* his wife Natalia facilitates his entry to Paradise, \* speaking wise and sacred words, \* and she counsels and teaches him to endure the pain \* of the tortures of martyrdom, resulting in awards bestowed from heaven, \* with fame and glory that never ends.

***For His mercy is great towards us, and the truth of the Lord endures forever.*** Adam's wife back in Paradise \* was the cause of his banishment, \* through the serpent's counsel. But now with Adrian, \* his wife Natalia facilitates his entry to Paradise, \* speaking wise and sacred words, \* and she counsels and teaches him to endure the pain \* of the tortures of martyrdom, resulting in awards bestowed from heaven, \* with fame and glory that never ends.

**Tone 1. *Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit.*** The zeal of the pious husband drew his godly wife to encourage him cheerfully. And

Adrian, the most excellent man, accepted Natalie's words, and finished the race of martyrdom. What a godly wife! She was not like Eve who brought death upon Adam, but

for her husband she induced eternal life. As we extol her and her husband, let us sing to Christ, “We pray You, give us Your help, at the intercessions of Your Saints.”

***Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.*** For all the powers of heaven.

Τῶν οὐρανίων ταγμάτων.

When You, O Savior, the lamb and shepherd, were crucified, \* Your pure and Virgin Mother, O my God, was there watching. \* She cried out in her grief, and she said, “O my Child, \* sweetest light of the universe, \* who can I watch You be stretched out upon a cross, \* as if You were but a criminal?”

### Aposticha

**Tone 1** O Martyrs, extolled. Πανεύφημοι μάρτυρες. OMartyr, you reddened with your blood, \* as with royal purple dye, your splendid garments, in which you now are reigning with the Lord, \* even as He promised, \* decorated with divine \* resplendence of your medals. And now we pray you intercede with Christ, \* and implore Him that surpassing peace \* and great mercy \* be upon our souls bestowed.

***God is wondrous in His saints.*** OAdrian, Martyr of the Lord, \* you avoided all the ways of sinful passions and took the saving track that leads to life. \* In immortal mansions \* you now dwell, all-lauded Saint, \* with all who have obeyed Christ. With them together, intercede with Christ, \* and implore Him that surpassing peace \* and great mercy \* be upon our souls bestowed.

***To the saints on His earth, in them the Lord magnified all His will.*** How novel and wonderful and great \* is the marvel that took place! How the most wise Martyr Natalie convinced her spouse to bear \* brutal mutilation \* for the sake of faith in Christ. \* Now who has ever seen such a thing or ever heard that such was done? \* She desired the love of her life \* be delivered \* to painful salvific death.

### **Tone 2. *Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit.*** O

h blameless team, chosen by the Lord! Oh loving couple, beloved of Christ! Oh excellent marriage, blest by God! Who cannot but marvel, when they hear about their super-human deeds? How did that woman withstand the brutal tyrant with such courage? She bolstered her husband, lest he succumb to torture, and she encouraged him to prefer to die for the faith, rather than to live. How godly were the words that wise Natalie wove! Her di i h i d h h d d l i Ad i k b f h h  
divine exhortations parted the heavens and made glorious Adrian known before the throne of the great King. “O holy couple, pray to God for us who observe your memory with love, that we be delivered from all trials and tribulations.”

***Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.*** You rose within three days.

Τριήμερος ἀνέστης.

O

Christ, when she who gave You birth \* beheld You hanging on the Cross, \* she cried loudly: \* O my Son, what is this \* strange mystery I witness? \* How is it that You die now, \* crucified in the flesh, O Giver of life?

### Apolytikion

**Tone 3** Your confession.

Θείας πίστεως.

You forsook the ways and false religion \* of your ancestors, for you considered \* the saving faith to be wealth irremovable. \* And as you followed the steps of the Lord of all, \* you were enriched by the gifts of His grace divine. \* Glorious Adrian, beseech Christ God fervently, \* entreating Him to save our souls.

**Tone 3. *Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit. Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.*** We have obtained the Cross of your Son, O Theotokos, as a rod of power. By it we subdue the insolence of the enemies. And with love we magnify you unceasingly.

**Troparion for Mary of Egypt Tone 8** In you the image was preserved with exactness, O Mother; for taking up your cross, you did follow Christ, and by your deeds you did teach us to overlook the flesh, for it passes away, but to attend to the soul since it is immortal. Wherefore, O righteous Mary, your spirit rejoices with the Angels.